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Kenya Institute of Curriculum Development

SENIOR SCHOOL LEARNER'S NOTES

(These are study notes, not an official KICD-published textbook)

GRADE 10

**COMMUNITY SERVICE LEARNING
NOTES**

Citizenship • Life Skills • Action Research • Social Entrepreneurship

Based on the KICD Grade 10 Community Service Learning Curriculum Design (2024)
For use by learners aged 14–16 years

HOW TO USE THIS BOOK

These are learner's notes developed to guide you through the Grade 10 Community Service Learning (CSL) curriculum. They are organised into four topics, matching the four strands of the curriculum: Citizenship, Life Skills, Action Research, and Social Entrepreneurship. Each topic is further divided into sub-topics that build your knowledge and skills step by step.

As you go through each sub-topic, you will find the following features:

- **Explains:** explains key concepts in simple, clear language, using local examples.
- **Key Idea boxes:** highlight the most important point to remember in a section.
- **Case Studies:** show how the concept applies in a real or realistic Kenyan community setting.
- **Reflection questions:** invite you to think personally about the topic — there are no 'wrong' answers here, only honest ones.
- **Worksheets:** give you a hands-on activity to practise the skills learnt, often involving your community.
- **End of Topic Questions:** help you check and revise your understanding of the whole topic.
- **Answer Key:** found in the final chapter, gives model answers to the End of Topic Questions for self-checking.

Remember, Community Service Learning is best learnt by doing. Take every worksheet seriously, engage genuinely with your community, and always reflect honestly on your experiences. This is how you will grow into a responsible, skilled, and caring citizen.

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ANSWER KEY

TOPIC 1: CITIZENSHIP

Citizenship is about how we belong to, care for, and contribute to the communities we live in. In this topic, you will learn what Community Service Learning (CSL) is, how to identify what your community needs, how to become an effective leader, and how to relate well with people from cultures different from your own. As you go through this topic, remember that being a good citizen is not just about knowing facts — it is about taking action that benefits the people around you.

1.1 Concept of Community Service Learning (6 Lessons)

Before you can serve your community well, you must first understand what Community Service Learning (CSL) actually means, and how it is different from simply doing a good deed once in a while.

A community is a group of people who share something in common. This could be a shared geographical area (like your neighbourhood or village), a shared identity (such as a school community or a religious group), or a shared purpose (such as a youth football club). Communities can be small, like your family, or large, like the nation of Kenya, or even the whole world.

Community Service is any voluntary activity carried out to benefit a community, such as cleaning a river, visiting a children's home, or planting trees. It is often a one-off activity that does not necessarily involve deep learning.

Community Service Learning (CSL), on the other hand, combines service to the community with structured learning and reflection. When you take part in CSL, you do not just perform an activity — you plan it, carry it out, and then reflect on what you learnt, what worked, what did not work, and how you can improve. This reflective practice is what transforms an ordinary activity into a powerful learning experience.

The main difference, therefore, is that Community Service focuses only on the outcome (the community benefiting), while Community Service Learning focuses on both the community benefiting AND the learner developing new knowledge, skills, values and attitudes.

Types of communities you will interact with during CSL include: the school community, your immediate neighbourhood, regional communities, the national community (Kenya), the global community, and even virtual (online) communities.

During your time in Senior School, you will be engaged in CSL through several components: community service projects done during the term, holiday community service carried out during school breaks, and an annual project that you will complete over the course of the year.

CSL is important because it helps you to develop as a responsible citizen. It helps you to apply what you learn in class to real situations, builds your character, and creates a strong bond between the school and the community it serves.



Key Idea

Community Service Learning = Service + Learning + Reflection. Remove reflection, and you are left with ordinary community service without the deep learning that CSL is designed to build.

Case Study: The Kibera Clean-Up Club

A group of Senior School learners in Nairobi noticed that a stream near their school was blocked with plastic waste, causing flooding in nearby homes during the rainy season. Instead of simply organising a one-day clean-up, the learners first researched the causes of the blockage, spoke to residents about their experiences, and then planned a series of clean-up days combined with a campaign to educate residents on proper waste disposal. After each clean-up, the learners held a reflection meeting where they discussed what they had learnt about waste management, teamwork, and communication. Over three months, flooding in the area reduced significantly, and the learners documented their journey in a class portfolio. This is an example of true Community Service Learning because the learners combined service with continuous learning and reflection.

Reflect and Discuss

- Think of a community you belong to. What makes it a community (shared identity, area, or purpose)?
- Recall a time you helped someone or a group without being asked. Was this Community Service or Community Service Learning? Explain your answer.
- Why do you think reflection is considered the most important part of CSL?

Worksheet 1.1: Mapping My Communities

Using the table below, identify one example of each type of community you belong to, and state one characteristic that defines each community.

#	Item / Task	Your Response
1	School community	
2	Immediate neighbourhood community	
3	Regional community	
4	National community	
5	Global community	
6	Virtual (online) community	

1.2 Community Needs (12 Lessons)

For CSL activities to be meaningful, they must respond to real needs within a community. A need is a gap between what currently exists and what is desired or required for the wellbeing of the community.

Community needs can be categorised into five broad areas: environmental needs (such as poor waste disposal or deforestation), political needs (such as lack of civic awareness or weak local governance), social needs (such as inadequate healthcare or education facilities), economic needs (such as unemployment or poverty), and technological needs (such as lack of access to computers or the internet).

Before addressing any need, learners must first carry out a needs assessment. This is the process of identifying and studying the existing gaps in a community through observation, interviews, questionnaires, or discussions with community members. A good needs assessment ensures that the CSL activity chosen truly matters to the community, rather than being based on assumptions.

Once needs have been identified, they should be documented in an organised way, such as in a simple database (a table or list, either on paper or on a computer/phone), showing the type of need, its location, who is affected, and how urgent it is.

Alongside needs, learners must also map out available resources in the community. Resources are anything that can be used to address a need — this includes people (skilled community members), money, materials, land, buildings, and even time. Recognising available resources helps learners plan realistic CSL activities instead of activities that are too ambitious for the resources at hand.

Community stakeholders are individuals or groups who have an interest in, or are affected by, the issue being addressed. These may include local administrators (chiefs, sub-chiefs), religious leaders, business owners, parents, non-governmental organisations (NGOs), and government offices. Building partnerships with stakeholders increases the chances that a CSL project will succeed and be sustained even after learners complete their activity.



Key Idea

A need is not the same as a want. A need is essential for wellbeing (e.g. clean water), while a want is something desired but not essential (e.g. a new phone). Good CSL activities target genuine needs.



Case Study: Water Scarcity in Kajiado

Learners at a Senior School in Kajiado County carried out a needs assessment in a nearby village and found that women and girls walked over five kilometres daily to fetch water, which affected school attendance for girls. The learners categorised this as both a social and economic need. They mapped resources in the area and discovered that a local NGO had unused water storage tanks and that community members were willing to contribute labour. By partnering with the area chief, the NGO, and parents, the learners helped organise the installation of a rainwater harvesting system at a nearby borehole. This case shows the importance of accurately identifying needs, mapping resources, and building stakeholder partnerships before taking action.

**Reflect and Discuss**

- List three needs you have observed in your local community this month. Categorise each one.
- Why is it risky to start a CSL project without first carrying out a needs assessment?
- Who are three stakeholders you could partner with for a CSL project in your area, and what role could each play?

Worksheet 1.2: Community Needs Survey

Interview at least three people in your neighbourhood (a parent, a neighbour, and a local leader).

Record their responses in the table below, then categorise each need mentioned (Environmental, Political, Social, Economic, or Technological).

#	Item / Task	Your Response
1	Person interviewed and their role in the community	
2	Need they mentioned	
3	Category of the need	
4	Possible resource available to address it	
5	A stakeholder who could help address it	

1.3 Leadership Development (6 Lessons)

Every successful CSL activity requires effective leadership. Leadership is the ability to guide, influence, and organise a group of people towards achieving a common goal.

Effective leaders share certain qualities: honesty, good communication skills, the ability to listen, confidence, empathy, accountability, and the ability to make sound decisions under pressure. As you take part in CSL, you will be given opportunities to practise these qualities.

There are different leadership styles that leaders may apply depending on the situation: Transformative leadership inspires followers to go beyond their own self-interest for the good of the group. Democratic leadership involves the leader consulting members before making decisions. Situational leadership involves adjusting one's style to fit the needs of a particular situation or team. Servant leadership focuses on the leader putting the needs of the team and community first, serving others before seeking to be served.

For CSL group activities to run smoothly, groups need clear guidelines (sometimes called a simple constitution). These guidelines should cover: leadership roles and responsibilities, procedures for holding elections, how roles will rotate among members, how leadership transitions will be handled, how daily activities will be run, and how challenges will be addressed.

When electing leaders for CSL activities, learners should follow the agreed procedures fairly and transparently. Candidates should be given a chance to speak to the group, sharing their vision and why they should be chosen, using persuasive but respectful public speaking.

After any leadership activity, it is important to reflect on how effective the guidelines and election process were, and to make improvements for future activities.



Key Idea

A good leader does not need a title to lead. Leadership is about influence and service, not position. Anyone in a CSL group can show leadership by taking initiative and helping others succeed.



Case Study: The Reluctant Leader

During a CSL tree-planting project, a quiet learner named Wanjiru was elected as the group's logistics coordinator, even though she had never held a leadership position before. She was unsure of herself at first, but she applied servant leadership by listening carefully to her group members, distributing tasks fairly, and always being the first to arrive and the last to leave. When conflicts arose over the distribution of seedlings, she used a democratic approach, letting the group vote on a fair distribution method. By the end of the project, her group had planted the highest number of trees among all groups in the school, and her classmates praised her calm and fair leadership style. Wanjiru's story shows that leadership styles can be learnt and applied even by first-time leaders.



Reflect and Discuss

- Think of a leader you admire (in school, community, or nationally). Which leadership style do they mostly use? Give evidence.
- Why do you think clear guidelines are necessary before electing leaders for a group activity?
- Describe a time you exercised leadership, even informally. What quality did you show?

Worksheet 1.3: Drafting Simple CSL Group Guidelines

In your CSL group, draft a one-page set of guidelines covering the items below. Present your draft to the class for feedback.

#	Item / Task	Your Response
1	List of leadership roles needed (e.g. Chairperson, Secretary, Treasurer, Logistics Coordinator)	
2	Procedure for electing leaders	
3	How roles will rotate (if at all)	

#	Item / Task	Your Response
4	How daily/weekly activities will be organised	
5	How disagreements within the group will be resolved	

1.4 Intercultural Competence (8 Lessons)

Kenya is home to more than 40 ethnic communities, as well as people of different religions, nationalities, and backgrounds. As you carry out CSL activities, you will often work with people who are culturally different from you. Intercultural competence is the ability to interact effectively and respectfully with people from cultures different from your own.

Intercultural competence has three main components: cultural awareness (understanding that your own culture is just one of many, and being aware of your own cultural biases), cultural knowledge (learning facts and information about other cultures), and cultural sensitivity (being respectful and thoughtful in how you relate to people of other cultures).

Sometimes, misunderstandings between cultures arise from stereotypes (oversimplified and often unfair beliefs about a group of people), misconceptions (incorrect beliefs based on limited or wrong information), and biases (unfair preferences or prejudices). These can lead to hostility if not addressed. Recognising these tendencies in ourselves is the first step towards overcoming them.

Positive intercultural interactions are built on values such as tolerance (accepting differences even when we do not agree with them), curiosity (wanting to learn about others), respect, empathy (trying to understand how others feel), open-mindedness, and humility.

As part of CSL, you will be encouraged to engage with community members from different cultural backgrounds through dialogue, to learn about their cultures, and to identify ways of promoting harmony where gaps exist. This could involve organising cultural exchange days, interviews, or joint community activities that bring different groups together.



Key Idea

Intercultural competence is not about becoming an expert in every culture — it is about approaching every person and culture with curiosity, respect, and an open mind.



Case Study: Building Bridges in Nakuru

In Nakuru, a Senior School with learners from Kikuyu, Kalenjin, Luo, Kamba, and Somali backgrounds noticed frequent tension and teasing based on ethnic stereotypes. A group of CSL learners decided to design an intercultural day where each cultural group in the school prepared a short presentation on their traditional food, dress, music, and values. Community elders from different communities were also invited to speak about the positive values shared across cultures, such as respect for elders and hospitality. After the event, learners reported a noticeable reduction in

ethnic teasing, and several new friendships were formed across ethnic lines. This case demonstrates how structured intercultural activities can reduce stereotypes and build social cohesion.



Reflect and Discuss

- Have you ever held a stereotype about another community that turned out to be false once you learnt more about them? What happened?
- How can you personally respond when someone makes an unfair comment about your own culture?
- Why is social cohesion important for the development of Kenya as a nation?

Worksheet 1.4: Cultural Interview

Interview one classmate or community member from a different cultural background than yours. Ask about one tradition, one value, and one food from their culture, then share your findings with the class.

#	Item / Task	Your Response
1	Name of person interviewed and their cultural background	
2	One tradition they shared	
3	One value they shared	
4	One food they shared	
5	One thing you learnt that surprised you	

End of Topic 1 Questions

Answer the following questions in your notebook. Model answers are provided in the Answer Key chapter at the end of this book.

1. Define the term Community Service Learning (CSL).
2. Distinguish between Community Service and Community Service Learning.
3. State the five categories that community needs can be classified into.
4. Explain three qualities of an effective leader.
5. Describe the four leadership styles discussed in this topic.
6. Explain the three components of intercultural competence.
7. Why is it important to map community resources before starting a CSL activity?

8. Using an example, explain how stereotypes can affect relationships between communities.

TOPIC 2: LIFE SKILLS

Life skills are the abilities that help us manage ourselves, relate well with others, and make good choices in everyday life. In this topic, you will learn about self-awareness in the community, how to resolve conflicts peacefully, and how to make responsible decisions. These skills will help you succeed not only in CSL activities but also in your personal, academic, and future professional life.

2.1 Self-Awareness in the Community (4 Lessons)

Self-awareness is the ability to understand your own character, feelings, motives, and desires. Public self-awareness, in particular, is the understanding of how others perceive you based on your behaviour, mannerisms, and choices in public settings.

Several factors influence public self-awareness, including the environment you are in, the people around you (peer influence), cultural expectations, past experiences, and feedback received from others.

Your public image is the impression that others form of you based on your mannerisms (the way you behave), your expressive qualities (how you communicate, dress, and carry yourself), and the decisions you make. A positive public image can open doors — it builds trust, respect, and opportunities — while a negative public image can close them.

Public consciousness, or mindfulness of others, means being aware of how your actions and words affect the people around you, and adjusting your behaviour to show respect and consideration for others in shared spaces.

Building a positive public image is a continuous process that involves being consistent in one's values, being honest, dressing appropriately for different occasions, communicating respectfully, and being willing to receive and act on feedback from others.

Key Idea

You cannot control how others feel about you, but you can control the choices, words, and actions that shape your public image.

Case Study: The Turnaround

Brian was known in his estate as a disrespectful teenager who often littered and used harsh language with younger children. After joining his school's CSL club, Brian took part in a community clean-up and received honest feedback from a neighbour about how his behaviour was perceived. Rather than getting defensive, Brian reflected on the feedback and made a deliberate decision to change: he began greeting elders respectfully, stopped littering, and started mentoring younger children in football. Within a few months, neighbours began describing him as 'the responsible young man' instead of 'that troublesome boy'. Brian's story shows that public self-awareness, when acted upon, can transform one's image and relationships within a community.

**Reflect and Discuss**

- How do you think your neighbours or community members currently perceive you? Why?
- Describe one habit you could change to improve your public image.
- Why do you think 'mindfulness of others' is an important skill in a shared community space, such as a matatu or marketplace?

Worksheet 2.1: My Public Image

Ask two people who know you well (a family member, teacher, or friend) to describe three words they would use to describe your public image. Reflect on their responses below.

#	Item / Task	Your Response
1	Three words given by Person 1	
2	Three words given by Person 2	
3	Which of these words match how you see yourself?	
4	One action you will take to improve your public image	

2.2 Conflict Resolution (6 Lessons)

Conflict is a natural part of human interaction. It occurs whenever there is a disagreement between two or more people or groups due to differences in needs, values, opinions, or interests. In the community, conflicts can arise over issues such as land boundaries, resource sharing, leadership disputes, or cultural misunderstandings.

There are several approaches to resolving conflict, including: negotiation (parties discuss directly to reach a compromise), mediation (a neutral third party helps guide the discussion), arbitration (a neutral party makes a binding decision), and collaborative problem-solving (parties work together to find a solution that benefits everyone).

Effective conflict resolution strategies include: staying calm and listening actively to all sides, separating the person from the problem (focus on the issue, not attacking the individual), looking for common ground, being willing to compromise, and involving a trusted mediator when direct discussion fails.

Peaceful conflict resolution promotes harmony, prevents the escalation of small disagreements into larger disputes (including violence), and strengthens relationships within a community. As a member of the community, you have an important role to play in modelling and encouraging peaceful ways of handling disagreements.

**Key Idea**

The goal of conflict resolution is not to determine who is right and who is wrong, but to find a fair solution that restores harmony and strengthens relationships.

Case Study: The Water Point Dispute

Two neighbouring homesteads in a rural community had a long-standing disagreement over the use of a shared water point, with each family accusing the other of using more than their fair share. The dispute escalated to the point where family members avoided speaking to each other. A group of CSL learners, guided by their teacher, offered to mediate. They invited both families to a neutral location, allowed each side to share their concerns without interruption, and helped them identify a fair rotation schedule for water collection. Both families agreed to the new schedule and thanked the learners for their patience and fairness. This case illustrates how mediation, patience, and active listening can resolve even long-standing community conflicts.

Reflect and Discuss

- Describe a conflict you witnessed or experienced recently. How was it resolved (or not resolved)?
- Which conflict resolution approach (negotiation, mediation, arbitration, or collaboration) do you think works best for conflicts between friends? Why?
- Why is it important to separate 'the person' from 'the problem' during conflict resolution?

Worksheet 2.2: Conflict Resolution Role Play

In pairs, act out a common conflict scenario (e.g. two learners disagreeing over who should lead a group project). Use one of the conflict resolution approaches learnt. Record your findings below.

#	Item / Task	Your Response
1	Scenario chosen	
2	Approach used (negotiation, mediation, arbitration, or collaboration)	
3	Outcome of the role play	
4	One lesson learnt from the exercise	

2.3 Responsible Decision-Making (6 Lessons)

Every day, we make decisions — some small (what to wear) and some significant (which friends to keep, how to spend money, or how to respond to peer pressure). Responsible decision-making is the ability to make choices that are constructive, safe, and consider the wellbeing of oneself and others.

The decision-making process generally follows these steps: identifying the problem or choice to be made, gathering relevant information, considering possible options and their consequences, choosing the best option based on your values, taking action, and evaluating the outcome.

Responsible decisions share certain qualities: they are made after careful thought (not impulsively), they consider the safety and wellbeing of oneself and others, they align with one's values, and they take into account both short-term and long-term consequences.

Irresponsible decisions, on the other hand, are often made hastily, under pressure, or without considering consequences. These can include giving in to peer pressure to engage in harmful behaviour, such as substance abuse, or making impulsive financial decisions.

To make responsible decisions, it helps to pause before acting, seek advice from trusted adults or mentors when unsure, consider 'what would happen if everyone made this same choice', and reflect on past decisions to learn from them.



Key Idea

Before making an important decision, ask yourself: 'Is this decision safe, is it aligned with my values, and will I be proud of this choice a year from now?'



Case Study: The Group Project Dilemma

During a CSL group project, Amina discovered that two of her group members had copied their entire report from the internet without proper acknowledgement, and they urged her to submit it as it was, arguing that the deadline was near. Amina faced pressure from her friends but decided to pause and think through the decision-making process. She considered the consequences of submitting plagiarised work (loss of integrity, potential disciplinary action, poor learning outcomes) versus telling the teacher and reworking the report honestly, even if it meant more effort. Amina chose to speak to her teacher, and together with her group, they redid the affected sections properly, though it required extra evening sessions. Though her friends were initially upset, they later thanked her, as their group avoided disciplinary action and produced a much stronger project. This case shows how pausing to think through consequences leads to more responsible outcomes.



Reflect and Discuss

- Describe a recent decision you made. Walk through the decision-making steps you followed (even if you did not realise it at the time).
- Why do people sometimes make irresponsible decisions even when they know the right thing to do?
- Who are the trusted people you can go to for advice when facing a difficult decision?

Worksheet 2.3: Decision-Making Practice

Choose a real or hypothetical dilemma relevant to teenagers (e.g. being pressured to skip class, or how to spend saved money). Apply the decision-making steps to it.

#	Item / Task	Your Response
1	State the dilemma/decision to be made	
2	List two possible options	
3	List one consequence of each option	
4	State your chosen decision and why it is responsible	

End of Topic 2 Questions

Answer the following questions in your notebook. Model answers are provided in the Answer Key chapter at the end of this book.

9. Define public self-awareness.
10. Explain three factors that influence public self-awareness.
11. Distinguish between negotiation, mediation, and arbitration as approaches to conflict resolution.
12. State the six steps in the decision-making process.
13. Explain why peaceful conflict resolution is important for community harmony.
14. Describe two qualities of a responsible decision.
15. Using an example, explain how public consciousness (mindfulness of others) can be demonstrated in a public space.

TOPIC 3: ACTION RESEARCH

Action research is a practical way of solving real problems by planning, acting, observing, and reflecting. This topic will introduce you to the meaning and cycle of action research, guide you on how to identify and analyse problems in your community, and take you through the process of implementing solutions and reflecting on their effectiveness.

3.1 Introduction to Action Research (8 Lessons)

Action research is a systematic process of investigating a problem in order to develop and test practical solutions, while learning and improving through continuous cycles of action and reflection. Unlike ordinary research, which may only describe or explain a problem, action research is aimed directly at solving it.

Action research has the following characteristics: it is reflective (learners think deeply about what they observe and do), continuous (it does not end after one attempt — it keeps improving), factual (based on real evidence, not assumptions), visible (its process and results can be seen and shared), practical (focused on real solutions, not just theory), and interesting (it engages learners actively).

The action research cycle consists of four stages: Plan (identify the problem and design an action to address it), Act (implement the planned action), Observe (collect data on the effects of the action), and Reflect (analyse what happened and decide on the next steps, which may lead to a new cycle of planning).

This cycle is repeated as many times as necessary until the problem is satisfactorily addressed, with each cycle building on the lessons of the one before it.

Action research is valuable in CSL because it teaches learners to be systematic problem-solvers who base their actions on evidence, rather than guesswork, and who continuously seek to improve their approach.



Key Idea

Remember the Action Research Cycle using the acronym P-A-O-R: Plan, Act, Observe, Reflect — and then repeat.



Case Study: Improving Attendance at a Community Library

A group of learners noticed that a small community library was rarely used by local children. In their first cycle, they planned an awareness campaign using posters (Plan), distributed the posters around the estate (Act), and observed a small increase in attendance over two weeks (Observe). During reflection, they realised most children did not know the library offered free internet access for homework. In the second cycle, they planned a new campaign that specifically highlighted the free internet access (Plan), implemented door-to-door visits explaining this (Act), and observed a much larger increase in attendance, especially among Senior School learners (Observe). Reflecting again, the group concluded that the second cycle was more effective because it addressed the actual reason for low attendance, rather than assuming the reason. This case shows how each cycle of action

research improves understanding and results.



Reflect and Discuss

- Why do you think action research is described as a 'cycle' rather than a straight line?
- Identify a small problem in your class or school. How would you Plan, Act, Observe, and Reflect on it?
- Why is it important for action research to be 'factual' and based on evidence?

Worksheet 3.1: My First Action Research Cycle (Mock)

Working in your CSL group, design a mock (practice) action research cycle addressing a simple classroom issue (e.g. noise during private study, or littering in class).

#	Item / Task	Your Response
1	State the problem	
2	Plan: what action will you take?	
3	Act: describe how you will carry out the action	
4	Observe: what will you look for or measure?	
5	Reflect: what might you learn, and what would you do differently next time?	

3.2 Problem Identification (10 Lessons)

The success of any action research project depends on correctly identifying the real problem to be solved. A common mistake is to jump straight into solutions without properly understanding the problem first.

Problem identification techniques include: careful observation of a scenario or situation, asking probing questions (What is happening? Who is affected? When and where does it occur? Why might it be happening?), and reviewing any available records or reports.

Once a problem has been identified, data collection tools are used to gather more detailed information about it. These include: observation tools (recording what you see happening), tally tools (counting how often something occurs), online forms (for collecting responses digitally), and checklists (a list of items to confirm or check off).

After data is collected, it must be analysed — this simply means organising, counting, and studying the data to understand the true nature and extent of the problem. At this level, analysis can be as simple as counting and tallying responses, then presenting them using charts, tables, or graphs.

Finally, the findings should be documented and managed properly, for example, in a report or digital file, so that they can be shared with others and referred to later. Good record-keeping requires integrity — data should not be altered or exaggerated to fit a particular conclusion.



Key Idea

A well-identified problem is a problem half-solved. Take time to observe and gather evidence before deciding what the 'real' problem is.



Case Study: The Overflowing Dustbins

Learners noticed that dustbins in their school compound were frequently overflowing, and initially assumed the cause was simply 'littering by learners'. Before acting, they designed a simple observation checklist and tally sheet, and monitored the dustbins for one week, recording how often they were emptied and by whom, as well as the times they became full. Their data revealed that the bins were actually only being emptied once a week instead of the required three times, due to a change in the cleaning schedule — the problem was not learner littering, but an administrative scheduling issue. By presenting this data to the school administration, the correct root cause was addressed, and the overflowing problem was resolved by adjusting the emptying schedule. This case demonstrates the importance of accurate problem identification using proper data collection tools, rather than relying on assumptions.



Reflect and Discuss

- Why might assuming the cause of a problem (without checking data) lead to the wrong solution?
- Which data collection tool (observation, tally, online form, or checklist) would be best for finding out how many learners walk to school? Why?
- Why is honesty (integrity) important when collecting and reporting data?

Worksheet 3.2: Designing a Simple Tally Tool

Choose a simple problem in your school (e.g. late-coming, noise levels in the library, or handwashing habits). Design a tally sheet to collect data on it for three days, then summarise your findings.

#	Item / Task	Your Response
1	Problem being investigated	
2	Design of tally sheet (draw or describe columns/rows)	
3	Total tally after 3 days	

#	Item / Task	Your Response
4	One conclusion drawn from the data	

3.3 Implementation Process (18 Lessons)

Once a problem has been clearly identified and understood, the next step is to identify a viable (realistic and workable) solution and implement it.

To identify the best solution, learners should brainstorm several possible solutions, then evaluate each one based on the time, human resources, and financial resources required, as well as its scope (how big or small the solution is) and its potential impact. This is often followed by class dialogue, consultation, and even voting to agree on the most viable solution.

Once a solution is chosen, an implementation plan should be developed. A good implementation plan includes: a timeline (when each activity will happen), milestones (key checkpoints to track progress), resource allocation (what resources are needed and where they will come from), personnel responsibilities (who is responsible for what), and reporting templates (how progress will be documented).

During implementation, learners carry out the planned activities in teams, continuing to collect data using checklists, observations, tallies, and trend analysis (looking at patterns over time), while holding regular reflective meetings to review progress and address challenges as they arise.

After implementation, a reflective report should be developed. This report should describe the process followed, the results achieved, the challenges faced, and the lessons learnt — and should reflect on how the entire action research process has strengthened the learner's skills and appreciation of CSL.

Finally, learners should share their reports with a wider audience, using digital or print formats such as charts, posters, videos, audio-visual presentations, the school website, or school social media pages — while always observing online safety.



Key Idea

A brilliant solution with a poor implementation plan often fails. Always pair a good idea with a clear timeline, defined responsibilities, and a way to track progress.



Case Study: The School Vegetable Garden Project

After identifying that many families in the neighbourhood struggled to afford fresh vegetables, a CSL group proposed starting a community vegetable garden on unused land near the school. They evaluated three possible solutions (a garden, a food donation drive, and a farming skills workshop) based on cost, time, and impact, and voted to proceed with the garden as it offered a sustainable, long-term solution. They created an implementation plan with a 10-week timeline, assigning roles such as land preparation team, watering team, and record-keeping team. During implementation, they tracked the growth of the vegetables and held weekly reflection meetings to solve challenges,

such as a pest infestation that they addressed using an organic pest control method suggested by a local farmer. At the end of the project, the group harvested vegetables that were distributed to ten families, and they shared their journey through a video posted on the school's social media page, carefully avoiding sharing any personal details of the families involved to protect their privacy online. This case illustrates the complete implementation process from planning through to sharing results responsibly.



Reflect and Discuss

- Why is it important to evaluate multiple possible solutions before choosing one to implement?
- What challenges do you think a CSL group might face during implementation, and how could they be addressed?
- Why should learners observe online safety when sharing CSL project reports on social media?

Worksheet 3.3: Implementation Plan Template

Using a community problem your class has identified, design a simple implementation plan using the template below.

#	Item / Task	Your Response
1	Chosen solution	
2	Timeline (list key activities with dates/weeks)	
3	Resources needed and their source	
4	Personnel responsibilities (who does what)	
5	How progress will be tracked and reported	

End of Topic 3 Questions

Answer the following questions in your notebook. Model answers are provided in the Answer Key chapter at the end of this book.

16. Define action research.
17. Outline the four stages of the action research cycle.
18. Explain any three characteristics of action research.
19. State four tools that can be used to collect data when identifying a community problem.
20. Explain the steps you would follow to select a viable solution to a community problem.

21. List the five components of a good implementation plan.
22. Why should learners observe online safety when sharing action research reports digitally?
23. Using a real or hypothetical example, describe how the action research cycle can be applied to solve a problem in your school.

TOPIC 4: SOCIAL ENTREPRENEURSHIP

Social entrepreneurship combines business thinking with a desire to solve social problems. In this topic, you will learn what makes social enterprises different from ordinary businesses, how to identify viable opportunities, how to plan a social enterprise, and how to mobilise the resources needed to bring your ideas to life.

4.1 Social Entrepreneurship Process (6 Lessons)

A social enterprise is a business that is created primarily to solve a social, environmental, or community problem, while also generating income to sustain itself. Unlike a purely charitable organisation, a social enterprise must be financially sustainable; and unlike a purely profit-driven business, its main purpose is social impact rather than maximising profit for owners.

Social enterprises are often described using the '4 Ps' framework: People (the enterprise benefits and involves the community), Profit (it must generate enough income to sustain its operations), Practice (it follows ethical and sustainable business practices), and Planet (it considers its impact on the environment).

The key difference between a social enterprise and other enterprises lies in its primary motive. A social enterprise measures success by both the social impact it creates and its financial sustainability, while a purely commercial enterprise mainly measures success through profit.

The social enterprise development process typically follows four stages: Opportunity Identification (finding a genuine need that can be addressed through an enterprise), Enterprise Planning (developing a clear plan for the enterprise), Resource Mobilisation (gathering the resources needed), and Implementation (putting the plan into action).

To promote social enterprises within a community, learners can design sensitisation materials such as posters, charts, flyers, and brochures that explain the benefits of social entrepreneurship to community members and potential partners.



Key Idea

Remember the 4 Ps of a social enterprise: People, Profit, Practice, and Planet. A true social enterprise balances all four — not just profit.



Case Study: EcoBricks for Schools

A group of Senior School learners in Mombasa noticed two problems: plastic waste was piling up in their neighbourhood, and a nearby primary school lacked enough furniture for its pupils. The learners researched 'eco-bricks' — a method of packing clean, dry plastic waste tightly into plastic bottles to create durable building blocks. They started a small social enterprise that collected plastic waste from the community (reducing pollution — Planet), employed local youth to clean and pack the bottles for a small fee (Profit and People), and sold the eco-bricks at an affordable rate to construct benches and modular furniture for schools (Practice and social impact). The enterprise

created income for the youth involved while addressing both an environmental problem and a school furniture shortage. This case shows how a social enterprise can balance profit-making with genuine community and environmental benefit.



Reflect and Discuss

- Think of a business in your area. Would you classify it as a social enterprise or a purely commercial enterprise? Why?
- Which of the '4 Ps' do you think is hardest for a new social enterprise to achieve, and why?
- Why do you think it is important for a social enterprise to be financially sustainable, rather than depending only on donations?

Worksheet 4.1: Spot the Social Enterprise

Research (using print media, digital devices, or interviews) two businesses in your area or country. For each, determine whether it is a social enterprise or an ordinary enterprise, giving reasons.

#	Item / Task	Your Response
1	Business 1 name and description	
2	Is it a social enterprise? Give reasons using the 4 Ps	
3	Business 2 name and description	
4	Is it a social enterprise? Give reasons using the 4 Ps	

4.2 Opportunity Identification (10 Lessons)

Before starting a social enterprise, learners must identify a genuine opportunity — a gap in the community that can be addressed profitably and sustainably through an enterprise.

The process begins with observing the local community to identify needs, similar to the needs assessment carried out under Citizenship. However, in social entrepreneurship, learners go a step further by asking: 'Which of these needs could be addressed through a small enterprise that generates income while solving the problem?'

Once several potential opportunities have been generated, they should be prioritised based on factors such as: how urgent or widespread the need is, the resources available to address it, the potential market (are people willing to pay for the product or service, even a small amount?), and the potential positive impact.

It is important to discuss potential opportunities with the community itself, including school administration and community leaders, to confirm that the idea is genuinely needed and likely to be supported.

Learners should also interview and observe the community to identify what resources (skills, materials, funding, partnerships) are already available that could support the chosen opportunity, and critically evaluate different opportunities before settling on the most viable one.



Key Idea

The best social enterprise opportunities sit at the intersection of three things: a real community need, a market willing to support it (even in a small way), and resources or skills you can access.



Case Study: The School Uniform Recycling Idea

Learners in a school in Kisumu observed that many families struggled to afford new school uniforms each year, while other families had outgrown uniforms in good condition sitting unused at home. They brainstormed several ideas — starting a tailoring shop, a fundraising drive, and a uniform exchange programme — and evaluated each based on cost, resources available, and community need. After interviewing parents and the school administration, they discovered strong support for a 'uniform bank' where good-quality used uniforms could be donated, lightly repaired/cleaned by a small team of learners (who would be paid a small fee from a minimal service charge), and resold at a fraction of the new price. This idea was selected as the most viable opportunity because it required minimal start-up capital, addressed a widespread need, and had strong community support. This case shows the process of generating, evaluating, and selecting a viable social enterprise opportunity in consultation with the community.



Reflect and Discuss

- List three needs in your community that could potentially be addressed through a small social enterprise.
- For one of the needs listed above, who would be your potential 'customers' or beneficiaries, and would they be willing to pay something for the solution?
- Why is it important to consult school administration and community leaders before adopting a social enterprise opportunity?

Worksheet 4.2: Opportunity Evaluation Matrix

List three possible social enterprise opportunities you have identified in your community. Score each one from 1 (low) to 5 (high) on Need, Resources Available, Market Potential, and Impact, then total the scores to identify the most viable opportunity.

#	Item / Task	Your Response
1	Opportunity 1: scores for Need / Resources /	

#	Item / Task	Your Response
	Market / Impact and Total	
2	Opportunity 2: scores for Need / Resources / Market / Impact and Total	
3	Opportunity 3: scores for Need / Resources / Market / Impact and Total	
4	Which opportunity scored highest, and will you select it? Why?	

4.3 Social Enterprise Planning (12 Lessons)

Once a viable opportunity has been identified, it must be developed into a clear social enterprise plan before implementation begins. A social enterprise plan is a document that outlines how the enterprise will operate, what it aims to achieve, and how it will be run.

A simple social enterprise plan template includes: Purpose (why the enterprise exists and what problem it addresses), Product/Service (what will be offered), Key Activities (the main actions needed to run the enterprise), Impact (the expected social and/or environmental benefit), Duties and Responsibilities (who will do what), and Resources (what is needed to operate, including materials, funding, and skills).

When developing a plan, it is useful to observe similar enterprises or 'competitors' in the area to learn from their strengths and avoid their weaknesses, and to strategise on how your enterprise can improve on existing offerings or serve an underserved gap.

A good plan is not created once and left unchanged. Learners should present their plan to classmates and the community for feedback, critique it constructively, and revise it based on the input received, before finalising it for implementation. This process of presenting, receiving feedback, and revising is essential to producing a strong, realistic plan.



Key Idea

A social enterprise plan is a living document. Expect to revise your first draft several times based on feedback — this is a normal and healthy part of the planning process, not a sign of failure.



Case Study: Planning 'Fresh Greens' Vegetable Delivery

A CSL group planning a vegetable delivery social enterprise for elderly residents in their estate (who found it difficult to walk to the market) drafted an initial plan with a purpose of 'helping elderly people access fresh vegetables'. When they presented this plan to their teacher and a group of elderly residents for feedback, they received important critique: the plan did not clearly state how orders would be collected, how vegetables would be sourced affordably, or how pricing would be set to remain both affordable to elderly residents and sustainable for the enterprise. The group revised their plan to include a simple weekly order form, a partnership with a local vegetable vendor for bulk purchase at a discount, and a small delivery fee to cover transport costs. The revised plan was far

more detailed and realistic, and it was successfully implemented, providing weekly deliveries to fifteen elderly households. This case highlights the value of presenting a plan for feedback before implementation.



Reflect and Discuss

- Why is it valuable to observe similar enterprises (competitors) before finalising your own plan?
- Think of a plan or idea you have had before. What feedback did you receive, and how did (or could) it improve your idea?
- Why should a social enterprise plan include both 'Impact' and 'Resources' sections?

Worksheet 4.3: My Social Enterprise Plan

Using the opportunity you selected in Worksheet 4.2, complete a simple social enterprise plan using the template below. Share it with a partner for feedback before finalising.

#	Item / Task	Your Response
1	Purpose	
2	Product/Service	
3	Key Activities	
4	Expected Impact	
5	Duties and Responsibilities	
6	Resources Needed	

4.4 Resource Mobilisation (8 Lessons)

Resource mobilisation is the process of identifying, gathering, and organising the resources needed to implement a social enterprise plan. Resources may include money, materials, equipment, skilled people, land, and time.

The first step in resource mobilisation is to identify exactly what resources are needed for the chosen social enterprise plan, then list and estimate the cost of each item. This leads to the development of a simple budget — a plan showing expected costs and, where applicable, expected income.

A good budget for a school-based social enterprise should be low-cost and realistic, making use of locally available materials wherever possible to reduce expenses. Where certain materials or resources are not locally available, learners must explore other ways of acquiring them, such as: donations (asking individuals or organisations to give resources for free), cost-sharing (multiple parties contributing

towards a shared cost), income-generating activities (raising funds through a small sale or service), partnerships (working with an organisation that can provide resources or expertise), and fundraising events.

Learners should identify and map out relevant stakeholders who could help provide the needed resources, and approach them respectfully with a clear explanation of the enterprise and what support is being requested.

Once resources have been gathered, they should be recorded in an inventory (a list of all resources available, showing quantity and source), and a plan should be put in place for how these resources will be managed and used responsibly to avoid wastage or misuse.



Key Idea

Do not wait until you have all the money you 'wish' you had. Start by listing what you already have access to locally, then mobilise only what is genuinely missing.



Case Study: Mobilising Resources for a Recycled Craft Enterprise

A group of learners planning to start a small enterprise making bags and mats from recycled materials needed sewing machines, thread, and recycled sacks, but had a very limited budget. They first listed all resources available locally: an old sewing machine at one member's home, a tailor in the community willing to volunteer training for two afternoons, and a shopkeeper willing to donate used sacks weekly. For the remaining needs — additional thread and needles — the group organised a small bake sale during break time, raising enough money to purchase the missing supplies. They recorded all resources gathered in a simple inventory book, noting the source and quantity of each item, and assigned one member to manage the inventory to prevent misuse. This case demonstrates that creative resource mobilisation, rather than large amounts of money, is often what determines whether a social enterprise can begin.



Reflect and Discuss

- List three resources already available in your school or community that could support a social enterprise idea.
- Which method of resource mobilisation (donations, cost-sharing, income-generating activities, partnerships, or fundraising) do you think would work best for a school-based enterprise? Why?
- Why is it important to keep an inventory of resources gathered for a social enterprise?

Worksheet 4.4: Simple Resource Budget

Using your social enterprise plan from Worksheet 4.3, list the resources needed, their estimated cost, and their likely source (local/available, or to be mobilised).

#	Item / Task	Your Response
1	Resource needed 1: estimated cost and source	
2	Resource needed 2: estimated cost and source	
3	Resource needed 3: estimated cost and source	
4	Total estimated budget	
5	Method(s) you will use to mobilise any missing resources	

End of Topic 4 Questions

Answer the following questions in your notebook. Model answers are provided in the Answer Key chapter at the end of this book.

24. Define a social enterprise.
25. Explain the '4 Ps' used to describe features of a social enterprise.
26. Outline the four stages of the social enterprise development process.
27. State four factors to consider when prioritising social enterprise opportunities.
28. List the six components of a simple social enterprise plan template.
29. Explain four ways of mobilising resources that are not locally available.
30. Why should a social enterprise plan be shared with the community for feedback before implementation?
31. Using an example, describe how a social enterprise differs from both a charity and a purely profit-driven business.

ANSWER KEY

This chapter provides model answers to the End of Topic Questions found at the end of each topic. Use these answers to check your own work. Note that for some essay-type questions, your answer may be worded differently but should cover the same key ideas.

Answers: Topic 1 — CITIZENSHIP

Q1. Define the term Community Service Learning (CSL).

Community Service Learning (CSL) is an approach that combines service to the community with structured learning and reflection, enabling learners to develop knowledge, skills, values and attitudes while benefiting the community.

Q2. Distinguish between Community Service and Community Service Learning.

Community Service focuses only on the activity and its benefit to the community (often a one-off activity), while Community Service Learning combines the service activity with deliberate, structured learning and reflection, so that the learner also grows and develops through the experience.

Q3. State the five categories that community needs can be classified into.

The five categories of community needs are: Environmental, Political, Social, Economic, and Technological.

Q4. Explain three qualities of an effective leader.

Any three of: Honesty (being truthful and trustworthy); Good communication skills (being able to clearly share ideas and listen to others); Empathy (understanding and caring about others' feelings); Confidence (believing in one's ability to guide others); Accountability (taking responsibility for decisions and their outcomes); Ability to make sound decisions, especially under pressure.

Q5. Describe the four leadership styles discussed in this topic.

Transformative leadership: inspires followers to go beyond self-interest for the good of the group. Democratic leadership: the leader consults members before making decisions. Situational leadership: the leader adjusts their style to fit the needs of a particular situation. Servant leadership: the leader prioritises the needs of the team/community and leads by serving others.

Q6. Explain the three components of intercultural competence.

Cultural awareness: understanding that one's own culture is one of many and recognising personal cultural biases. Cultural knowledge: learning facts and information about other cultures. Cultural sensitivity: being respectful and thoughtful in interactions with people of other cultures.

Q7. Why is it important to map community resources before starting a CSL activity?

Mapping community resources helps learners plan realistic CSL activities that match the resources actually available, preventing them from planning activities that are too ambitious or impossible to implement with the resources at hand.

Q8. Using an example, explain how stereotypes can affect relationships between communities.

Example: If community members hold a stereotype that a particular ethnic group is 'unfriendly' or 'aggressive' without any factual basis, this can lead to reduced interaction, unfair treatment, or even hostility between the communities, weakening social cohesion. When learners engage in intercultural dialogue (as in the Nakuru case study), such stereotypes can be broken down, leading to improved relationships.

Answers: Topic 2 — LIFE SKILLS

Q1. Define public self-awareness.

Public self-awareness is the understanding of how others perceive you based on your behaviour, mannerisms, and choices in public settings.

Q2. Explain three factors that influence public self-awareness.

Any three of: The environment one is in; the people around them (peer influence); cultural expectations; past experiences; feedback received from others.

Q3. Distinguish between negotiation, mediation, and arbitration as approaches to conflict resolution.

Negotiation: parties discuss directly with each other to reach a compromise, without outside help.

Mediation: a neutral third party helps guide the discussion between the parties but does not make the

final decision. Arbitration: a neutral third party listens to both sides and makes a binding decision that the parties must follow.

Q4. State the six steps in the decision-making process.

1) Identify the problem or choice to be made; 2) Gather relevant information; 3) Consider possible options and their consequences; 4) Choose the best option based on one's values; 5) Take action; 6) Evaluate the outcome.

Q5. Explain why peaceful conflict resolution is important for community harmony.

Peaceful conflict resolution prevents small disagreements from escalating into larger disputes or violence, restores and strengthens relationships between the parties involved, and promotes overall harmony and cooperation within the community.

Q6. Describe two qualities of a responsible decision.

Any two of: They are made after careful thought, not impulsively; they consider the safety and wellbeing of oneself and others; they align with one's personal values; they take into account both short-term and long-term consequences.

Q7. Using an example, explain how public consciousness (mindfulness of others) can be demonstrated in a public space.

Example: Lowering one's voice and avoiding playing loud music in a matatu or public space so as not to disturb other passengers demonstrates mindfulness of others' comfort and wellbeing in a shared public space.

Answers: Topic 3 — ACTION RESEARCH

Q1. Define action research.

Action research is a systematic process of investigating a problem in order to develop and test practical solutions, while learning and improving continuously through cycles of action and reflection.

Q2. Outline the four stages of the action research cycle.

Plan, Act, Observe, Reflect.

Q3. Explain any three characteristics of action research.

Any three of: Reflective (learners think deeply about what they observe and do); Continuous (the process does not end after one attempt, but keeps improving); Factual (based on real evidence, not assumptions);

Visible (the process and results can be seen and shared); Practical (focused on real solutions); Interesting (engages learners actively).

Q4. State four tools that can be used to collect data when identifying a community problem.

Any four of: Observation tools; Tally tools; Online forms; Checklists.

Q5. Explain the steps you would follow to select a viable solution to a community problem.

Brainstorm several possible solutions; evaluate each based on time, human and financial resources required, scope, and potential impact; engage in class dialogue, consultation and voting to agree on the most viable solution.

Q6. List the five components of a good implementation plan.

Timeline; Milestones; Resource allocation; Personnel responsibilities; Reporting templates.

Q7. Why should learners observe online safety when sharing action research reports digitally?

To protect the privacy and safety of individuals involved (e.g. avoiding sharing personal details of community members), to avoid sharing harmful or inappropriate content, and to prevent misuse of shared information by malicious persons online.

Q8. Using a real or hypothetical example, describe how the action research cycle can be applied to solve a problem in your school.

Learner responses will vary; a good answer should clearly describe a real school problem and show how it was (or could be) addressed by Planning an action, Acting on the plan, Observing the results using a data collection method, and Reflecting on the outcome to decide the next step, potentially leading to a second improved cycle.

Answers: Topic 4 — SOCIAL ENTREPRENEURSHIP

Q1. Define a social enterprise.

A social enterprise is a business created primarily to solve a social, environmental, or community problem, while also generating enough income to sustain itself.

Q2. Explain the '4 Ps' used to describe features of a social enterprise.

People: the enterprise benefits and involves the community. Profit: it must generate enough income to sustain its operations. Practice: it follows ethical and sustainable business practices. Planet: it considers its impact on the environment.

Q3. Outline the four stages of the social enterprise development process.

Opportunity Identification, Enterprise Planning, Resource Mobilisation, and Implementation.

Q4. State four factors to consider when prioritising social enterprise opportunities.

Any four of: How urgent or widespread the need is; the resources available to address it; the potential market (willingness of people to pay); the potential positive impact.

Q5. List the six components of a simple social enterprise plan template.

Purpose; Product/Service; Key Activities; Impact; Duties and Responsibilities; Resources.

Q6. Explain four ways of mobilising resources that are not locally available.

Donations (individuals or organisations giving resources for free); Cost-sharing (multiple parties contributing towards a shared cost); Income-generating activities (raising funds through a small sale or service); Partnerships (working with an organisation for resources/expertise); Fundraising events (any four of these with brief explanation).

Q7. Why should a social enterprise plan be shared with the community for feedback before implementation?

Sharing the plan with the community allows for constructive feedback that can reveal gaps or weaknesses in the plan (such as unclear pricing or sourcing), leading to a more realistic and workable plan before resources and time are committed to implementation.

Q8. Using an example, describe how a social enterprise differs from both a charity and a purely profit-driven business.

A charity typically relies on donations and does not need to generate its own income, focusing purely on social benefit. A purely profit-driven business focuses mainly on maximising profit for its owners, with limited focus on social impact. A social enterprise sits between the two: like a charity, its primary purpose is social impact, but like a business, it must generate sufficient income to sustain its own operations (e.g. the EcoBricks case study addressed environmental and furniture needs while also paying local youth for their work).